

The Six Healing Sounds

??? Liù Zì Jué (Seated Form)

ORIGINS

The Six Healing Sounds trace to the Daoist internal-alchemy tradition, first recorded in written form by the physician and Maoshan Daoist Táo Hóngjǐng in the fifth or sixth century CE, and refined over the following centuries by court physicians including Sūn Simiǎo. Many twentieth-century teachers carried the practice forward, each pairing the sounds with their own seated posture, breath, and colour visualisation. The version presented here is the one passed down through direct teaching, seated posture by seated posture, sound by sound.

WHAT IT IS FOR

Each of the five solid organs, plus the Triple Warmer, is understood in Chinese medicine to store a specific negative emotional pattern that accumulates through stress and habit. Exhaling the organ's corresponding sound, never voiced loudly, more a long, controlled release of breath, is said to discharge what has been stored there. Paired with visualising the organ's colour and its positive virtue, the negative pattern is converted into its healthy counterpart.

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- 6

1 Lung Sound

"Sssssss", like steam escaping

LUNG

METAL · AUTUMN · WHITE

Releases → Cultivates: **Grief and sadness**, transformed into courage and integrity.



EXECUTE

Sit toward the edge of the chair, feet shoulder-width apart, hands resting palms-up on the thighs. Raise both hands overhead, palms up, with the fingertips of each hand touching the other, and look up. Rest the tongue behind the closed teeth and, with one long, slow exhalation, make the sound "Sssssss."

VISUALISATION

Lower the hands back to the lap, palms up. Smile inwardly to the lungs and picture a white light surrounding them, and feel the quality of courage settle in. Repeat the full sequence, position, sound, visualisation, three times in total.

2 Kidney Sound

"Wooooo", as if blowing out a candle

KIDNEY

WATER · WINTER · BLUE

Releases → Cultivates: **Fear**, transformed into gentleness and generosity.



EXECUTE

Sit toward the edge of the chair, feet shoulder-width apart. Lean forward and clasp both hands around the knees, and look up. Shape the lips into an "O," as though preparing to blow out a candle, and with one long, slow exhalation produce the sound "Wooooo."

VISUALISATION

Return the hands palms-up to the lap. Smile inwardly to the kidneys and picture a blue light surrounding them, and feel the quality of gentleness and generosity settle in. Repeat three times in total.

3 Liver Sound

"Shhhhhh"

LIVER

WOOD · SPRING · GREEN

Releases → Cultivates: **Anger**, transformed into kindness.



EXECUTE

Sit toward the edge of the chair, feet shoulder-width apart. Raise the hands palms-up overhead and interlock the fingers, leaning slightly to the left, and look up. Rest the tongue near the palate and, with one long, slow exhalation, produce the sound "Shhhhhh."

VISUALISATION

Return the hands palms-up to the lap. Smile inwardly to the liver and picture a green light shining upon and inside it, and feel the quality of kindness settle in. Repeat three times in total.

4 Heart Sound

"Hawwww"

HEART

FIRE · SUMMER · RED

Releases → Cultivates: **Hatred, impatience, and self-pity**, transformed into love, joy, and honour.



EXECUTE

Sit toward the edge of the chair, feet shoulder-width apart. Raise the hands palms-up overhead and interlock the fingers, leaning slightly to the right, and look up. With the mouth wide open, exhale a deep breath slowly, producing the sound "Hawwww."

VISUALISATION

Return the hands palms-up to the lap. Smile inwardly to the heart and picture a red light shining upon and inside it, burning away any hatred or self-pity as the quality of love and joy settles in. Repeat three times in total.

5 Spleen Sound

"Whooooo", from the throat, owl-like

SPLEEN · PANCREAS

EARTH · LATE SUMMER · YELLOW

Releases → Cultivates: **Worry**, transformed into openness, balance, and fairness.



EXECUTE

Sit toward the edge of the chair, feet shoulder-width apart, fingertips of each hand touching, palms up, placed beneath the left ribcage. Inhale and, holding the breath, gently press the sides of the hands in and slightly up under the rib. Rest the tongue near the palate and, on a long, slow exhalation, produce the sound "Whooooo" from the throat, like an owl's call.

VISUALISATION

Return the hands palms-up to the lap. Smile inwardly to the spleen and pancreas and picture a yellow light surrounding them, and feel the quality of openness and fairness settle in. Repeat three times in total.

6 Triple Warmer Sound

"Heeeeee"

TRIPLE WARMER · SAN JIAO

WHOLE-BODY · CLOSING



PURPOSE

The Triple Warmer has no single organ correlate; it is the pathway distributing qi and regulating temperature through the upper cavity (heart, lungs), middle cavity (liver, stomach, spleen), and lower cavity (kidneys, bladder, intestines). Rather than releasing one emotion, this closing sound settles and evens out everything the previous five sounds have moved.

EXECUTE

Lie flat on the back if possible, or lean back in the chair if not. With the mouth open, exhale slowly, producing the sound "Heeeeee." Picture a long, gentle rolling pin passing over the body from the forehead down to the toes, flattening and evening out everything raised by the five sounds before it. Repeat three times in total.

PRACTICE NOTES

- Practise the sounds in the order given, the sequence is not arbitrary; each organ is addressed in turn before the Triple Warmer settles the whole body at the close.
- Each sound is exhaled on breath, never voiced loudly or strained, closer to a long sigh shaped into a sound than to speech or singing.
- Traditionally practised seated, though the postures may be adapted for standing practice where a chair isn't available.

TIMING

- Best practised daily, ideally at the same time each day.
- The classical guidance follows the seasons, spend more time on the Lung Sound in autumn, the Kidney Sound in winter, the Liver Sound in spring, and so on, though the full set of six may always be practised together as a complete daily routine.

SUITABLE FOR

- Gentle and accessible for most students regardless of prior experience, since the practice involves breath, sound, and visualisation rather than strength or flexibility.
- As with any practice involving held or directed breath, students who are pregnant or managing a respiratory or cardiovascular condition should modify or consult their own physician as needed.